

36 Vocabulary

36.1 TRADITION, LUCK, AND SUPERSTITION

I **told a white lie** and said the dress looked good on her.

tell a white lie

[say something that is not true to avoid upsetting someone]



She always **drops hints** about the presents she wants.

drop a hint

[say something indirectly]



Varinder **started a rumor** that Sonia stole some money.

start / spread a rumor

[to start / continue saying things that may or may not be true]



Paulo loves to **gossip**. He's always talking behind people's backs.

gossip

[talk about other people, often in a negative way]



I **have a sneaking suspicion** that he won't come to the party tonight.

have a sneaking suspicion

[have a persistent idea about something with little evidence]



I don't **believe in** ghosts.

believe in something

[think that something exists or is true]



I haven't ever broken a bone.

Knock on wood!

knock on wood (US)

touch wood (UK)

[wish for good luck, or avert bad luck]



Close your eyes and **make a wish**.

make a wish

[hope for something to happen]



I **have serious misgivings** about this new policy.

have serious misgivings / doubts

[have a strong feeling that something is not right]



She was such a **tattletale** at school.

tattletale (US) / telltale (UK)

[somebody who tells an authority figure when another person has done something wrong]

